

Checklist

Management 101 Checklist

What to expect from a good manager

- ☐ Has regular 1:1s with me
- ☐ Uses 1:1s for discussion, not just status updates
- ☐ Treats me like a person, not just a worker
- ☐ Builds trust and human connection
- ☐ Gives feedback regularly
- ☐ Gives praise publicly when appropriate
- ☐ Gives criticism privately and promptly
- ☐ Helps me improve my work beyond day-to-day execution
- ☐ Helps me navigate workplace challenges
- ☐ Helps me understand promotion expectations
- ☐ Identifies stretch opportunities for growth
- ☐ Connects my work to team and company goals
- ☐ Helps me find training, learning, or career resources
- ☐ Advocates for my growth and advancement
- ☐ Helps me focus on what matters most

What I am responsible for

- ☐ Think about what I want from my career
- ☐ Bring topics and agendas to my 1:1s
- ☐ Ask for help when I am stuck
- ☐ Ask for feedback, including constructive feedback
- ☐ Speak up when I am unhappy
- ☐ Ask for projects, opportunities, or stretch work I want
- ☐ Ask directly about promotion or raise expectations
- ☐ Take ownership of my growth and happiness at work
- ☐ Set my own work-life boundaries
- ☐ Use my manager as a resource, not a mind reader

How to work well with a manager

- ☐ Bring solutions, not only problems
- ☐ Ask for advice instead of only demanding fixes
- ☐ Give my manager grace when they are imperfect
- ☐ Recognize that I can only control my side of the relationship
- ☐ Decide whether a problem is my manager, my situation, or me
- ☐ Choose managers carefully when evaluating jobs

Self-assessment

- ☐ I have had at least one manager I would call good
- ☐ I can name what made that manager effective
- ☐ My current 1:1s are useful
- ☐ My manager knows enough about me to support me well
- ☐ I receive meaningful feedback
- ☐ My manager has helped me set work goals
- ☐ I know what I need to ask for next